Quince

Team G27

# Own the Second Purchase

How we lift 90-day repeat from 24% to ~31%, inside the same $120M and with no discounts

Our retargeting and lifecycle plan, built on what we found in Adobe Customer Journey Analytics

Case Competition World Cup · Graduate Track · October 2026

# We win the second purchase and lift repeat 24% → ~31%

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**Situation** Viral TikTok and Instagram moments brought Quince a huge wave of first buyers. **Complication** But CAC is up 29% to $62, only 24% buy again within 90 days (peers: 30–35%), and 60% of the fixed $120M goes to renting reach on social platforms.

**Our answer: we blend all three options.** **Retargeting gets us moving, owned channels bring buyers back, CJA holdouts decide every dollar**

## Lever 1 Capture every buyer

### Quince Passport

A box card registers the piece; SMS at checkout and app tracking let us reach everyone

**66%**

of repeat buyers come from the 24.5% who engage; app users still come back at 21.5% after order one

## Lever 2 Win the Golden Month

### Material Journeys

A care guide on arrival, then a second category by day 21, moving cashmere buyers into home

**2.7×**

more week-2 repeat for engaged buyers than for all buyers (directional: ~48 buyers a week)

## Lever 3 Never pay twice

### Never Pay Twice Engine

Daily CJA lists keep buyers we can already reach out of paid retargeting

**23.0% vs 23.4%**

retargeted vs organic repeat: the ads aren't buying loyalty

**24% → ~31%**

90-day repeat, range 29.5-33% · target +6 pts

**−12 to −14%**

blended CAC on Exhibit J's definition, $62 → ~$54 · target −10%

**$9M re-aimed**

$7.5M goes to owned, net $0; +6 pts is worth ≈ $30M revenue a year (Exh. J)

**Same $120M · No discounts, ever · We prove every move in Adobe CJA**

Source: case sections 1, 3, Exhibits A, G, I, J; Adobe CJA A2, A3b, A5, A6, Cohort Table (appendix 9–13). The forecast is our base case (appendix 22); budget steps in appendix 21. Strict new-customer CAC ≈ −8% (appendix 26).

# Renting reach costs 29% more than two years ago, and it keeps the fewest customers

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## THE MARKET

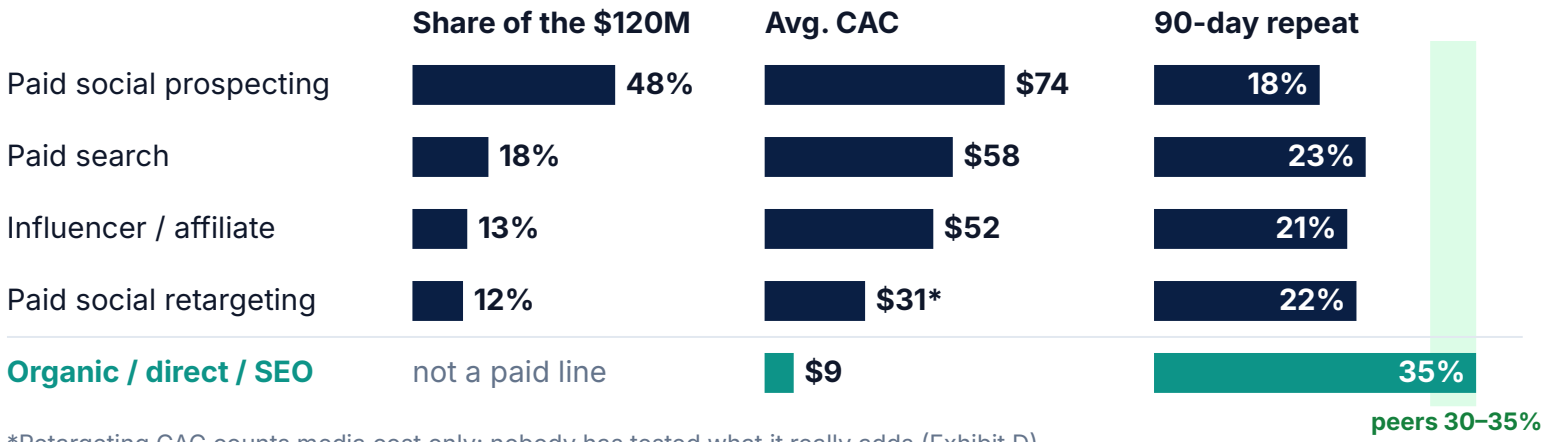
| | |
|---|---|
| **~$180B** | US online apparel, accessories and home; growing mid-single digits (case, illustrative) |
| **17.1%** | of US retail sales were online in Q2 2026 (US Census) |
| **+12.2%** | e-commerce growth vs +6.7% for all retail (US Census) |

## FOUR FORCES RAISE THE COST OF RENTING REACH

| | |
|---|---|
| **35–50%** | **Signal loss** of iOS users allow tracking, so retargeting sees less |
| **+12%** | **Dearer auctions** Meta price per ad, year on year |
| **≥3×** | **Misread credit** how far ad-lift estimates are often off (Gordon) |
| **44.8** | **Cautious consumer** record-low sentiment, so price can't be the answer |

**Result for Quince: blended CAC**
**$48 → $62 · +29% in two years**

## RENTED CHANNELS COST MOST AND KEEP LEAST · EXHIBITS D, G (ILLUSTRATIVE)




*Retargeting CAC counts media cost only; nobody has tested what it really adds (Exhibit D).
Organic is earned, not bought.

**Owned channels are underfunded:** app buyers repeat **38%** and email/SMS **29%** vs 13% web-only; 3-year LTV **$410 vs $155**. Yet owned gets **5%** of the $120M.

**So what: renting reach keeps getting dearer while owned customers keep paying back, so we move spend to owned inside the same $120M**

Source: case §2, §3, Exhibits B, D, E, G, H (illustrative); US Census (Q2 2026); Adjust (Q2 2025); AppsFlyer (Apr 2025); Meta Q2 2026 results; Gordon et al. (2019); UMich Surveys of Consumers (May 2026). Links in appendix 27.

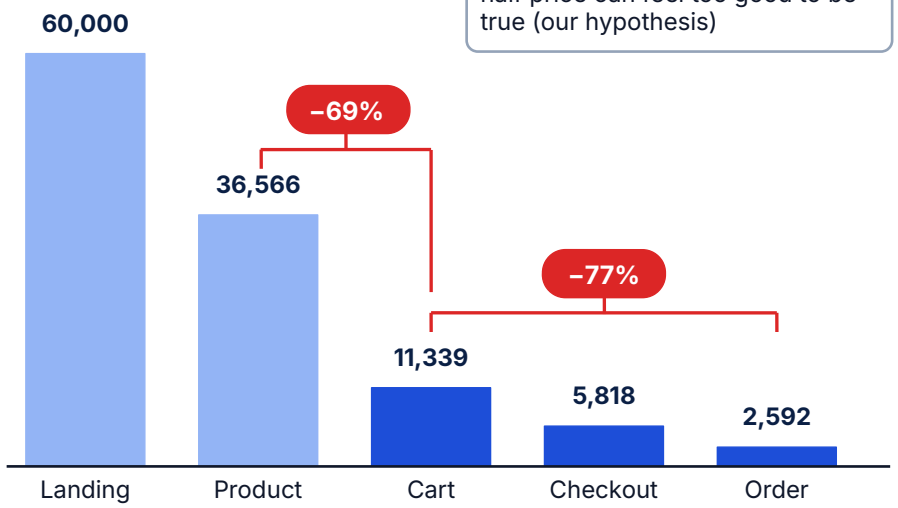
# 77% of carts stall, yet the 25% of buyers who engage make up 66% of repeaters

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## Where the funnel breaks

People at each step (Fallout)

**Price signals quality:** cashmere at half price can feel too good to be true (our hypothesis)




**Only 1** of ~5,500 carts that stop before checkout gets a follow-up email (Flow)

## Who comes back

Repeat rate in the CJA window

Engaged with email, SMS or app (A2) **28.1%**

App after order one (A5, n=265) **21.5%**

SMS after order one (A5, n=315) **11.7%**

Not engaged (A2) **4.7%**

**24.5%** of buyers engage, yet they are **66%** of repeat buyers (A2)

## When, and what next

Repeat orders in week 2 (Cohort)

Engaged **5.6%**

All buyers **2.1%**

*Half of engaged repeats land in weeks 1–4*

**Repeat by category touched (A6)**

Home **20.8%**

Jewelry **19.5%**

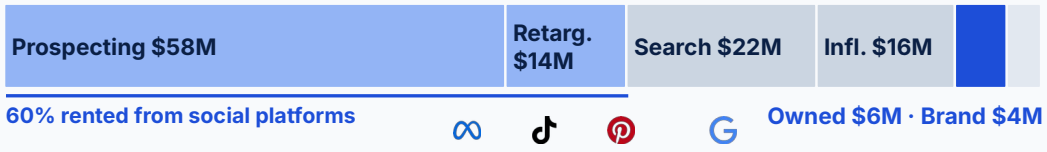
Beauty **18.5%**

Cashmere **13.7%**

**Cashmere: touched by 40.7% of buyers, repeats least**

## Where the $120M goes

FY2026 (Exhibit G)



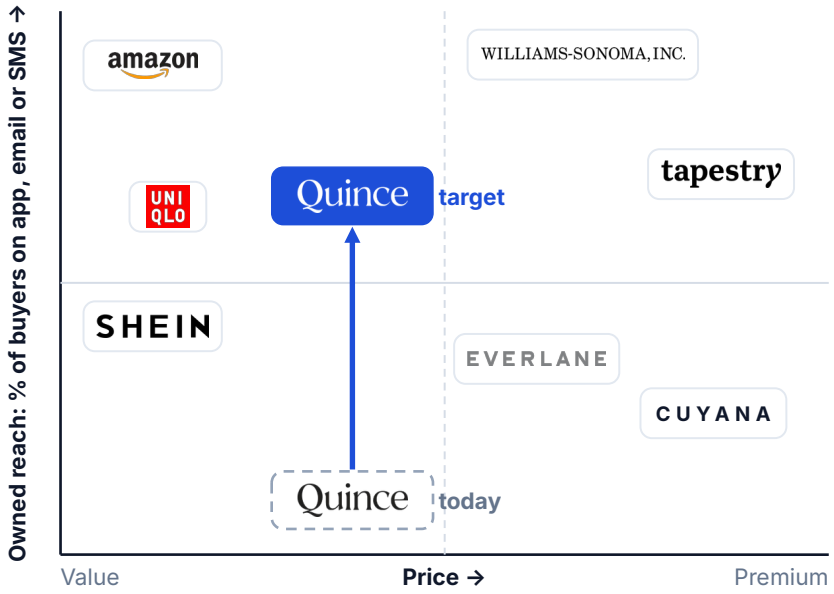

**5%** owned: $1.43 per active customer (A, G). **$31** retargeting CAC is untested, and may count sales that would have happened anyway (D)

Source: Adobe CJA, Quince Case Data View, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026 (Fallout A1, segments A2/A5, Flow A4, Cohort Table, A6), appendix 9–13; case Exhibits A, D, G. CJA repeat covers ~3 months, so we use it for relative gaps, not against the case's 24%.

# Rivals can copy a discount overnight, but not factory-direct cost plus buyers who opted in

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## Price vs depth of owned relationship (our judgment)




### What a rival can copy, and how fast

| | |
|---|---|
| **A 20% discount** | Overnight |
| **Journeys and suppression lists** | A quarter or two |
| **Factory-direct cost + opted-in buyers** | Years |

## WHAT THREE RIVALS TEACH US

amazon

**Paid reach is an auction we can't win**
Amazon's ad business: $19.8B a quarter, +26%

EVERLANE

**Owned channels alone aren't a moat**
Everlane had strong email and SMS, and still ended up selling to Shein

WILLIAMS-SONOMA, INC.

**Trust has to come from proof, not comparisons**
Williams-Sonoma sued Quince over "dupes"

Our move: straight up the map

**We keep the factory-direct price and build the relationship rivals can't buy**

Source: case Exhibit M, section 7; Amazon Q2 2026 results; Bloomberg Law, NPR (May 2026); The Fashion Law (30 Sep 2026); Williams-Sonoma 10-K. Map positions and copy speeds are our judgment; full rival table in the case pack.

# The customer data is ready; we close three gaps for $4.8M inside the owned line

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READY TODAY

**Stitched person ID** across web, app, email and SMS (Exhibit L)

THREE GAPS WE FUND AS THE OWNED LINE GROWS $6M → $13.5M

**Activation**
CJA audiences to journeys and ad platforms
**$1.5M**
Month 3 · Marketing ops

**Lifecycle team and creative**
Today it's built for mass email blasts
**$2.8M**
Month 6 · CMO

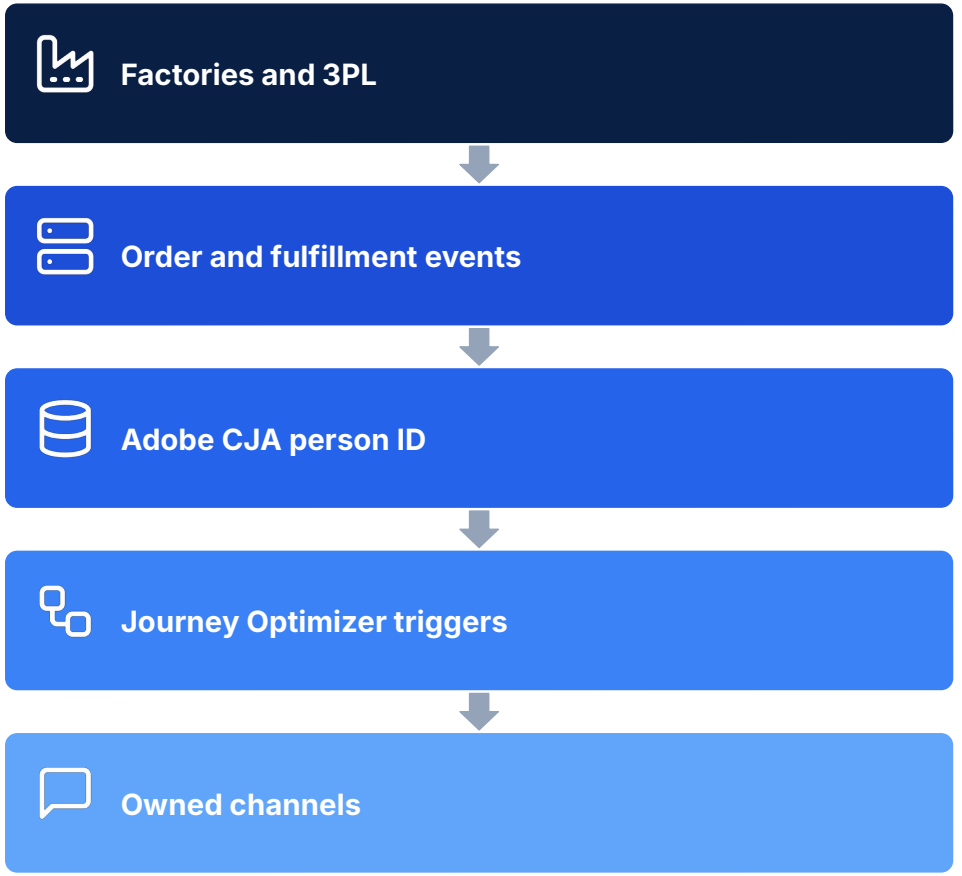
**Growth–analytics alignment**
Weekly holdout council; incremental scorecards
**$0.5M**
Month 3 · CMO + CFO

**Partly there, and we fix it in the pilot:** app tracking · 3PL order events · SMS consent split

**The pilot runs on Option A's $2–3M inside today's $6M; the rest follows only as each step proves itself.**

## How shipping events become journeys

Material Journeys, end to end (appendix 24)




Source: case sections 1, 3, 4, 7; Exhibits A, I, K, L; costs, owners and dates from our plan (owned line $6M → $13.5M, appendix 21). Adobe CJA builds the audiences; Real-Time CDP or Journey Optimizer sends them out.

# We test for 90 days in the South, and the first $4M moves only if the holdout proves it

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| LEVER · WHY | IN THE SOUTH PILOT · SET UP WK 1–4, LAUNCH 5–8, MEASURE 9–12 | GATE 1 PASS MARK, MONTH 3 | OWNER · PAID FROM |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 **Capture every buyer** 77% of carts stall; only 24.5% of buyers engage | **Quince Passport** Box card, SMS opt-in at checkout, order tracking in the app, and cart reminders at 1h and 24h | **Engaged share ≥ 2× holdout** our aim: from 1 in 4 to 1 in 2 buyers engaged | **CRM + app** Option A, inside $6M |
| 2 **Win the Golden Month** Repeat peaks in week 2; cashmere repeats least, 13.7% | **Material Journeys v1** The delivery email sends a care guide; we suggest a second category by day 21 | **30-day repeat +2 pts vs holdout** read weekly on the CJA Cohort Table | **CRM team** Option A, inside $6M |
| 3 **Never pay twice** Retargeted buyers repeat 23.0%, same as organic 23.4% | **Never Pay Twice Engine** Every day we send Meta, Google and TikTok the buyers we can already reach, so they stop seeing ads | **Orders per $ ≥ holdout** guardrail: new customers drop by less than 2% | **Paid media** $14M line, $0 extra |

## THEN WE MOVE MONEY ONLY WHERE THE HOLDOUT PROVES IT · 14 PROGRAMS, 0 DISCOUNTS

**South pilot**
Weeks 1–12 · 10% holdout
3 flagships; 11 programs wait

**Retargeting → owned**
Month 3 · $4M
if Gate 1 passes

**Search → owned**
Months 4–6 · $3M
if the branded geo test proves it

**Prospecting → owned**
Months 7–9 · up to $2M
only if it's shown to be over-credited

**Gate 2 → target**
Month 9 ≥ 28%
~31% repeat by month 18

Source: case Exhibits G, I, N; Adobe CJA A1, A2, A3b, A6, Cohort Table; our plan. 3 flagships in the pilot; 11 more programs wait for Gate 1 (appendix 20). We start in the South (fastest new-customer growth, lower email/SMS opt-in, Exhibit N), then the Midwest.

# Appendix

## ADOBE CJA EVIDENCE


9 Fallout

10 Attribution IQ

11 Cohort Table

12 Flow

13 Segments


## BACKUP ANALYSIS


14 Why a blend

15 Issue tree

16 Seven moments of the journey

17 Every cart adder's path (flowchart)

18 Never Pay Twice engine

19 The weekly CJA loop

20 Fourteen programs, explained

21 How the $120M moves, line by line

22 Path to ~31% repeat

23 Attribution IQ insight

24 Material Journeys build plan

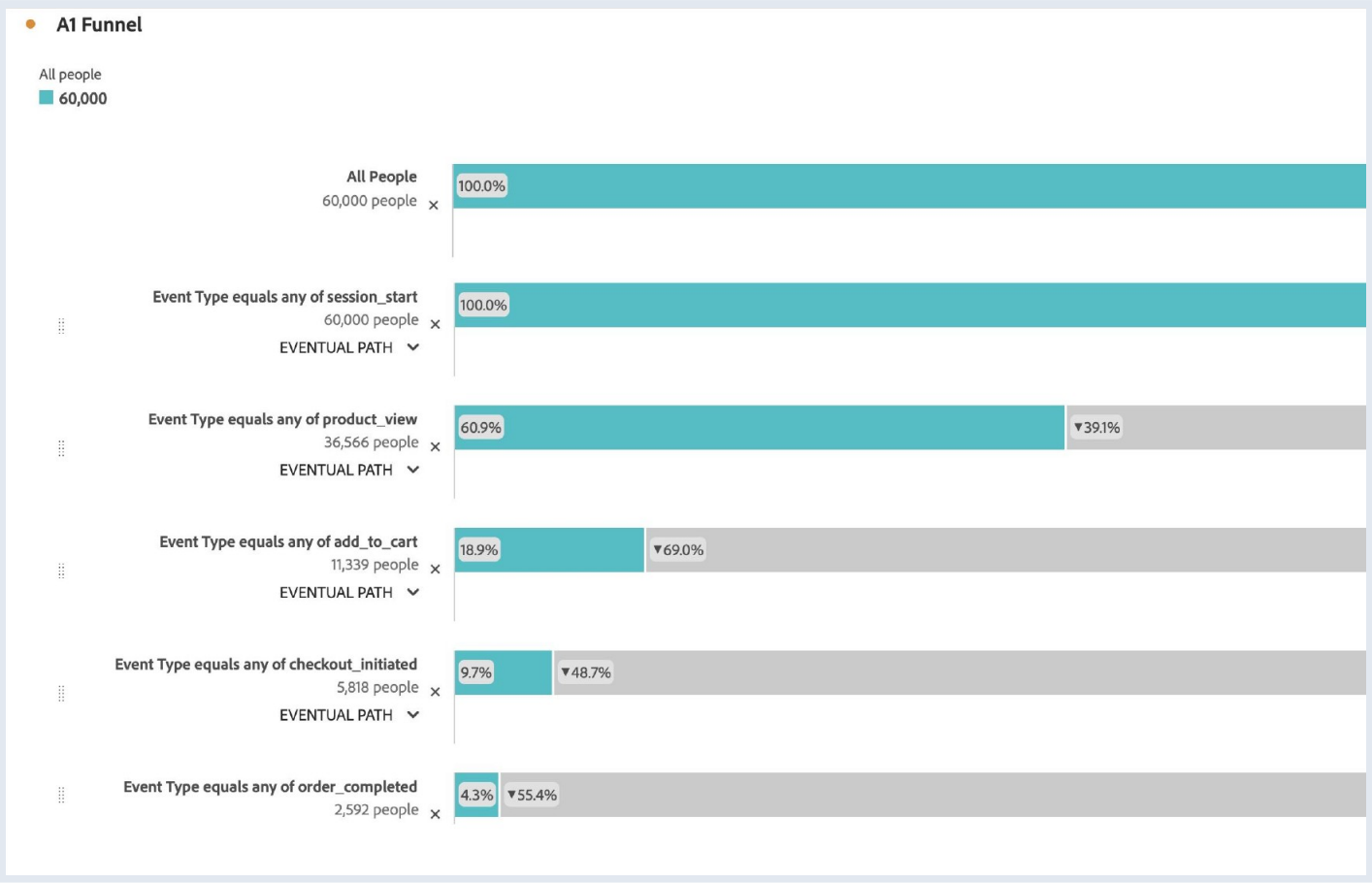
25 Risks

26 Every number and its source

27 Sources

# 77% of cart adders never order

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**77% of cart adders never order, against a ~70% category benchmark (Exhibit C). The cart is where Quince falls behind, so recovering carts is our fastest test**

Source: Adobe CJA, Fallout, Quince Case Data View, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026, 60,000 people. 69% of product viewers never add to cart.

# Standard attribution can't tell us what retargeting really adds

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## Order Revenue Attribution Comparison

| Marketing Channel<br>Page: 1/ 1 Rows: 10 1-8 of 8 | Order Revenue<br>Last Touch \| Person \| 90 Days<br>Jan 1 – Apr 30<br>$337,044 out of $337,044 | Order Revenue<br>First Touch \| Person \| 90 Days<br>Jan 1 – Apr 30<br>$337,044 out of $337,044 | Order Revenue<br>Linear \| Person \| 90 Days<br>Jan 1 – Apr 30<br>$337,044 out of $337,044 | Order Revenue<br>Participation \| Person \| 90 Days<br>Jan 1 – Apr 30<br>$337,044 out of $337,044 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1. Paid Social Prospecting | $139,932 41.5% | $143,356 42.5% | $143,588 42.6% | $153,968 45.7% |
| 2. Organic / Direct / SEO | $53,763 16.0% | $47,758 14.2% | $50,192 14.9% | $56,763 16.8% |
| 3. Paid Social Retargeting | $43,395 12.9% | $41,836 12.4% | $42,278 12.5% | $47,416 14.1% |
| 4. Paid Search | $43,231 12.8% | $44,978 13.3% | $43,930 13.0% | $46,180 13.7% |
| 5. Influencer / Affiliate | $40,814 12.1% | $42,991 12.8% | $42,049 12.5% | $44,820 13.3% |
| 6. Email | $9,063 2.7% | $10,546 3.1% | $8,829 2.6% | $29,408 8.7% |
| 7. App Push | $4,656 1.4% | $2,562 0.8% | $3,555 1.1% | $9,631 2.9% |
| 8. SMS | $2,192 0.7% | $3,018 0.9% | $2,622 0.8% | $11,526 3.4% |

**Last touch, first touch and linear give owned channels ~5% (4.8 · 4.8 · 4.5%) and retargeting ~12.5% (12.9 · 12.4 · 12.5%). Attribution can't rank them, so we let holdouts decide the budget**

Source: Adobe CJA, Attribution IQ, Order Revenue ($337,044) by Marketing Channel; Last Touch, First Touch, Linear, Participation; 90-day lookback. Algorithmic model unavailable on this view; Participation is not a credit model.

# Engaged buyers repeat 2.7x more in week 2

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**Cohort table**

Retention

Inclusion: **Orders (Events)** >= 1 Return: **Orders (Events)** >= 1

| Cohort | Included | +1 Weeks | +2 Weeks | +3 Weeks | +4 Weeks | +5 Weeks | +6 Weeks | +7 Weeks | +8 Weeks | +9 Weeks | +10 Weeks | +11 Weeks | +12 Weeks |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Average retentio | 201 | 3 1.3% | 4 2.1% | 3 1.4% | 3 1.6% | 3 1.3% | 3 1.6% | 3 1.3% | 2 0.8% | 3 1.7% | 2 1.3% | 1 0.6% | 0 0.0% |
| Dec 28 - Jan 3 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| Jan 4 - Jan 10 | 158 | 3 1.9% | 5 3.2% | 5 3.2% | 5 3.2% | 2 1.3% | 5 3.2% | 2 1.3% | 0 | 4 2.5% | 3 1.9% | 2 1.3% | |
| Jan 11 - Jan 17 | 215 | 3 1.4% | 6 2.8% | 3 1.4% | 4 1.9% | 7 3.3% | 1 0.5% | 6 2.8% | 4 1.9% | 2 0.9% | 4 1.9% | | |
| Jan 18 - Jan 24 | 191 | 4 2.1% | 5 2.6% | 2 1.0% | 2 1.0% | 1 0.5% | 6 3.1% | 3 1.6% | 2 1.0% | 6 3.1% | | | |
| Jan 25 - Jan 31 | 239 | 1 0.4% | 7 2.9% | 5 2.1% | 4 1.7% | 4 1.7% | 3 1.3% | 1 0.4% | 3 1.3% | | | | |
| Feb 1 - Feb 7 | 190 | 1 0.5% | 5 2.6% | 2 1.1% | 3 1.6% | 2 1.1% | 1 0.5% | 3 1.6% | | | | | |
| Feb 8 - Feb 14 | 216 | 3 1.4% | 4 1.9% | 1 0.5% | 3 1.4% | 5 2.3% | 5 2.3% | | | | | | |
| Feb 15 - Feb 21 | 242 | 1 0.4% | 3 1.2% | 6 2.5% | 4 1.7% | 1 0.4% | | | | | | | |
| Feb 22 - Feb 28 | 212 | 2 0.9% | 4 1.9% | 2 0.9% | 4 1.9% | | | | | | | | |
| Mar 1 - Mar 7 | 246 | 4 1.6% | 5 2.0% | 4 1.6% | | | | | | | | | |
| Mar 8 - Mar 14 | 223 | 6 2.7% | 4 1.8% | | | | | | | | | | |
| Mar 15 - Mar 21 | 230 | 6 2.6% | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Mar 22 - Mar 28 | 249 | | | | | | | | | | | | |

All buyers

**Cohort table Engaged**

Retention

Inclusion: **Orders (Events)** >= 1, **Engaged** Return: **Orders (Events)** >= 1

| Cohort | Included | +1 Weeks | +2 Weeks | +3 Weeks | +4 Weeks | +5 Weeks | +6 Weeks | +7 Weeks | +8 Weeks | +9 Weeks | +10 Weeks | +11 Weeks | +12 Weeks |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Average retentio | 48 | 2 2.9% | 3 5.6% | 2 4.4% | 2 4.0% | 1 2.3% | 2 3.1% | 1 2.7% | 1 1.7% | 2 3.8% | 1 2.3% | 1 1.9% | 0 0.0% |
| Dec 28 - Jan 3 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 |
| Jan 4 - Jan 10 | 52 | 3 5.8% | 4 7.7% | 4 7.7% | 4 7.7% | 0 | 3 5.8% | 0 | 0 | 4 7.7% | 2 3.8% | 2 3.8% | |
| Jan 11 - Jan 17 | 63 | 1 1.6% | 5 7.9% | 3 4.8% | 3 4.8% | 4 6.3% | 1 1.6% | 3 4.8% | 4 6.3% | 2 3.2% | 2 3.2% | | |
| Jan 18 - Jan 24 | 47 | 2 4.3% | 3 6.4% | 1 2.1% | 1 2.1% | 1 2.1% | 2 4.3% | 3 6.4% | 1 2.1% | 2 4.3% | | | |
| Jan 25 - Jan 31 | 49 | 1 2.0% | 2 4.1% | 3 6.1% | 3 6.1% | 2 4.1% | 2 4.1% | 0 | 0 | | | | |
| Feb 1 - Feb 7 | 42 | 0 | 3 7.1% | 2 4.8% | 2 4.8% | 0 | 0 | 2 4.8% | | | | | |
| Feb 8 - Feb 14 | 51 | 1 2.0% | 3 5.9% | 1 2.0% | 0 | 2 3.9% | 3 5.9% | | | | | | |
| Feb 15 - Feb 21 | 59 | 0 | 2 3.4% | 5 8.5% | 3 5.1% | 1 1.7% | | | | | | | |
| Feb 22 - Feb 28 | 57 | 2 3.5% | 3 5.3% | 2 3.5% | 3 5.3% | | | | | | | | |
| Mar 1 - Mar 7 | 61 | 3 4.9% | 5 8.2% | 3 4.9% | | | | | | | | | |
| Mar 8 - Mar 14 | 59 | 3 5.1% | 3 5.1% | | | | | | | | | | |
| Mar 15 - Mar 21 | 53 | 3 5.7% | | | | | | | | | | | |
| Mar 22 - Mar 28 | 31 | | | | | | | | | | | | |

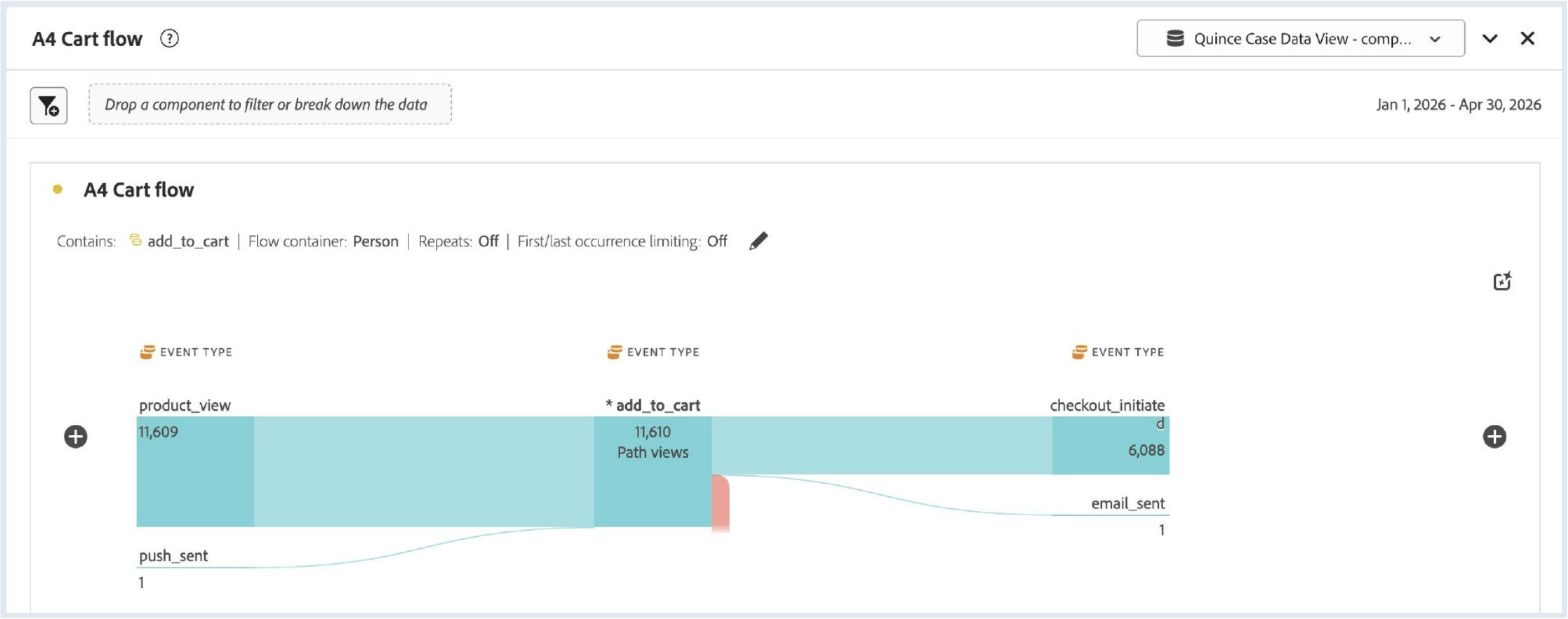
Engaged buyers (inclusion segment)

**Engaged buyers repeat 2.7× more in week 2 than all buyers (5.6% vs 2.1%), and half their repeats land in weeks 1–4. Cohorts are small (~48 engaged buyers a week), so we read this as directional**

Source: Adobe CJA, Cohort Table, inclusion and return Orders ≥ 1, weekly, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026; right panel uses the Engaged inclusion segment.

# Almost no stalled cart gets a follow-up email

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**Of 11,610 cart paths, 6,088 go on to checkout and only 1 is followed by an email. A simple cart reminder is our fastest win**

Source: Adobe CJA, Flow from add_to_cart (next step), Person container, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026. 11,610 = path views; 11,339 = people (Fallout).

# App users come back at double the rate of SMS users

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**A2 · Repeat by engagement (any time)**

**A5 · Engaged after order one**

**A2 Repeat by engagement**

| Segments<br>Page: 1/ 1 Rows: 400 1-4 of 4 | Buyers<br>People<br>Jan 1 – Apr 30<br>2,592 | Repeat buyers<br>People<br>Jan 1 – Apr 30<br>271 |
|---|---|---|
| 1. Engaged | 636 24.5% | 179 66.1% |
| 2. SMS engaged | 319 12.3% | 59 21.8% |
| 3. Email engaged | 74 2.9% | 74 27.3% |
| 4. App engaged | 266 10.3% | 69 25.5% |

**A5 Engaged before repeat**

| Segments<br>Page: 1/ 1 Rows: 400 1-4 of 4 | People<br>Jan 1 – Apr 30<br>674 |
|---|---|
| 1. Order then App | 265 39.3% |
| 2. Order then App then Order | 57 8.5% |
| 3. Order then SMS | 315 46.7% |
| 4. Order then SMS then Order | 37 5.5% |

**Engaged buyers are 24.5% of buyers but 66% of repeaters (A2 overstates this, since owned visits only log at purchase). After order one, app users still repeat 21.5% vs 11.7% for SMS (A5, the cleaner test)**

Source: Adobe CJA, freeform tables with engagement segments (A2) and sequential segments after order one (A5, n = 265 app, 315 SMS), 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026.

# Why we blend paid speed with owned retention

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**B** Option B

## Paid precision and suppression

- ✓ Results in weeks, $0 incremental
- ✗ On its own: exposed to signal loss, and builds no lasting relationship

**A** Option A

## Owned lifecycle precision

- ✓ Lowest cost per touch; insulated from ATT
- ✗ On its own: limited to today's list, where only 1 in 4 buyers engage

**C** Option C

## Attribution-based reallocation

- ✓ The way we decide, for good
- ✗ On its own: 6–12 months before anyone trusts it, and hard to adopt

**Proves fast**
Savings held in the $14M line until a holdout proves them

**Builds it**
Capture grows the list; journeys earn order two

**Proves it**
Runs from day 1 and decides every tranche

B gives us fast proof, A's owned reach shields us from B's signal loss, and C's holdouts tell us whether either is working

→ **We scale only what beats the CJA holdout, and stop anything that doesn't**

Source: case section 4 (Options A, B, C), Exhibit I (cost and timing) and Exhibit K (risk matrix); our analysis.

# Four root causes behind the 24% repeat rate

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**Why is 90-day repeat 24% and blended CAC $62 on a fixed $120M?**

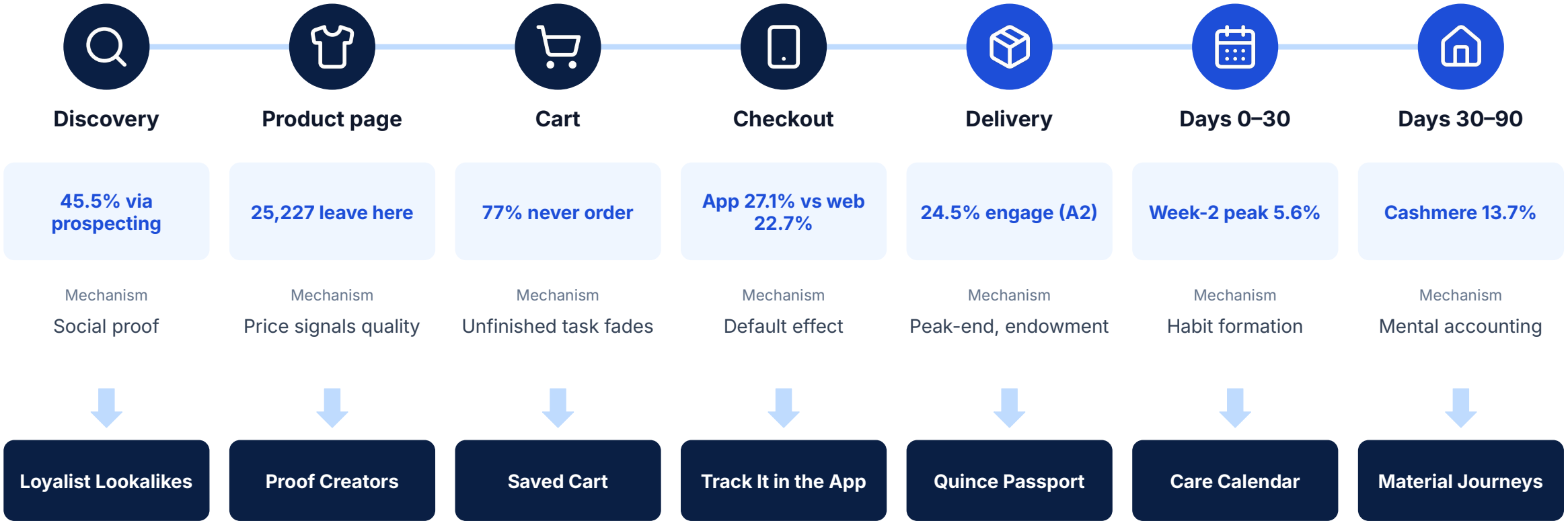
| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Money** | **Spend may pay for demand that comes anyway**<br>Retargeted buyers repeat no better than organic: 23.0% vs 23.4% (A3b); a holdout will tell us | **Never pay twice** |
| **Customer mind** | **One-product buyers**<br>Cashmere is touched by 40.7% of buyers but repeats 13.7% (A6) | **Win the Golden Month** |
| **Customer journey** | **The purchase leaks**<br>77% of cart adders never order; 1 of ~5,500 cart paths stopping before checkout gets an email (A1, A4) | **Capture every buyer** |
| **Brand trust** | **Found, not yet trusted**<br>25,227 people leave after a product view (A1) | **Trust thread, all levers** |

→ **Repeat = engaged share × engaged repeat + non-engaged share × non-engaged repeat; CAC = $120M ÷ new customers**

Source: our analysis; Adobe CJA panels A1–A6 and A3b; case Exhibits D and G.

# We ask for the relationship when the box opens

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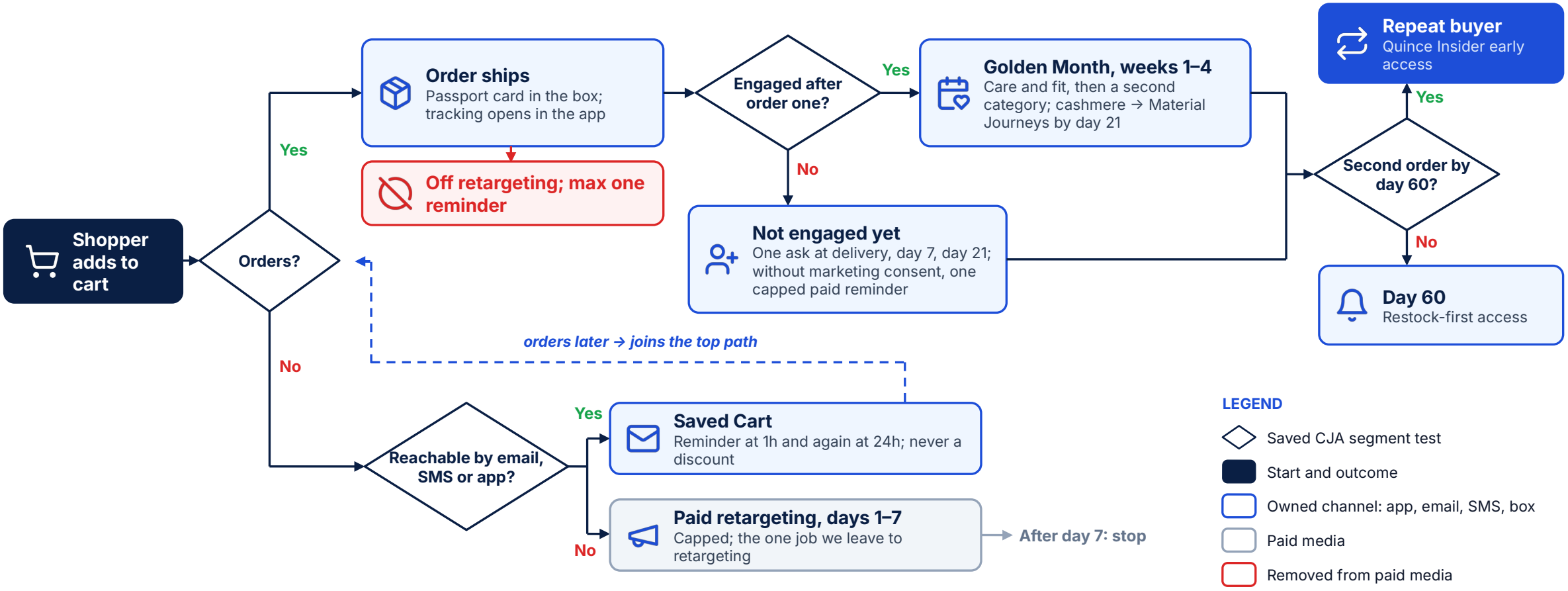



**Trust peaks when the parcel opens, so that's when we ask for the relationship, never with a discount**

Source: Adobe CJA panels A1, A2, A4, A5, A6 and Cohort Table; the mechanisms are our hypotheses, and the pilot tests them.

# Every cart: owned channels first, paid second

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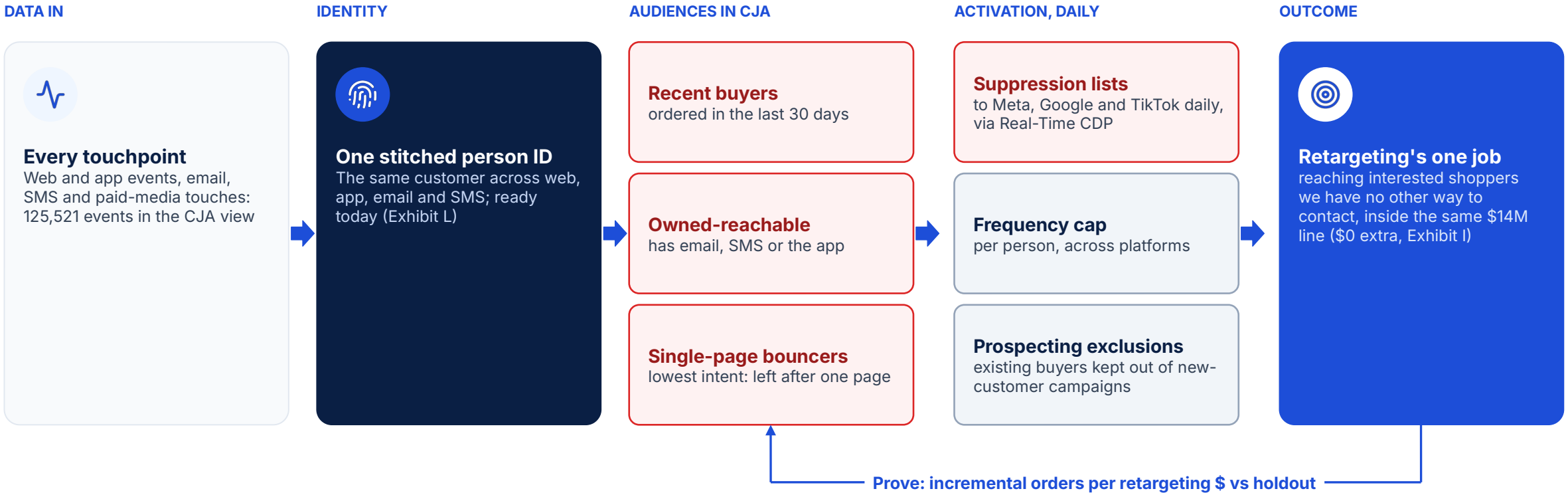



**Each diamond is a saved CJA segment, so the same rule sends the message and measures it**

Source: Adobe CJA segments (A1, A2, A4, A6, Cohort Table); our targeting design. Message timings are our pilot choices, tested against the holdout.

# We stop paying for ads to customers we already have

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**Why test it:** retargeted buyers repeat no better than organic (23.0% vs 23.4%, A3b) and attribution barely moves, so only a holdout can show what retargeting is worth. We leave the prospecting budget, which brings 45.5% of buyers, unchanged.

**We stop paying to reach customers we can already message; the prospecting budget stays the same**

Source: Adobe CJA, Quince Case Data View (125,521 events, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026), segments A3b and A1; case Exhibits D, I, L; our design.

# Our weekly loop: how analytics and growth work together

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### 1 Diagnose

Option C

Read Fallout, Flow, Cohort Table and Attribution IQ on one stitched person ID

OWNER **Head of Analytics**
RHYTHM Weekly

### 2 Target

Options A + B

Turn findings into saved CJA segments: abandoners, engaged, cashmere-first, recent buyers

OWNER **Analytics + CRM**
RHYTHM Weekly

### 3 Activate

Options A + B

Send segments to lifecycle journeys and to paid-media suppression lists

OWNER **Marketing ops**
RHYTHM Daily sync

### 4 Prove

Option C

Read every move against a randomized holdout: 10% in the South pilot

OWNER **Head of Analytics**
RHYTHM Weekly council

### 5 Reallocate

Option C

Move money across lines only when the holdout proves it; otherwise it stays

OWNER **CMO + CFO**
RHYTHM Gates: months 3, 9

**What CJA proves tells us where to look next and what to do next**

**Why it matters:** On its own, Option C takes 6–12 months to trust (Exhibit I). Running it as a weekly loop from day one lets A and B act within weeks, while C decides every budget move.

**Growth and analytics share one workspace, one holdout and one way of deciding**

Source: case section 4 (Options A, B, C), Exhibits I and L; owners and rhythm are our operating design.

# 14 programs, zero discounts, no new budget

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## 1 Capture every buyer

**Quince Passport**
A card in every box: scan it to register the piece for care tips, easy exchanges and restock alerts, and we ask for SMS or the app

**Track It in the App**
Order tracking opens in the app, where carts convert at 27.1% vs 22.7% on web (A1)

**Saved Cart**
A reminder within hours, with fit and return promises, never a discount

**Restock-First Waitlist**
"Text me when it's back" on real sell-outs gives people a reason to opt in

## 2 Win the Golden Month

**Material Journeys**
Before it arrives, we explain how the material is made and how to care for it (no supplier names); by day 21, a second category (cashmere → home)

**Care Calendar**
Seasonal care reminders keep us in touch with cashmere buyers

**Gift Ledger**
Customers save gift dates, and we send picks 14 days before

**Quince Insider**
Early access earned by engagement, not spend

**Beauty Refill**
Refill reminders timed to each product's use cycle

**Cashmere Second Life**
Take-back for recycling, rewarded with early access

## 3 Never pay twice

**Never Pay Twice Engine**
Daily CJA lists tell Meta, Google and TikTok which buyers we can already reach, so we stop paying to retarget them

**Loyalist Lookalikes**
We model new prospects on repeat buyers, not one-time buyers

**Proof Creators**
Wear-tests and fabric close-ups instead of discount codes

**The Fitting Room**
A members-only pop-up for app users, one city, one season, to try fabrics in person; light on assets, no store

**0** discounts

**14** programs tested against a holdout

**$0** new budget

Source: our strategy. Each program sits in one lever, targets one behaviour, and has a KPI we can read in CJA. None of them cuts price.

# We move $9M out of rented lines, but only when holdouts prove it

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| LINE: TODAY → TARGET | WHAT CHANGES | EVIDENCE | DECISION RULE |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Paid social prospecting**  **$58M → $56M if proven** | Months 7–9: South test on ~$16.2M; existing buyers excluded, lookalikes on repeaters | Brings 45.5% of buyers (A3b) but its buyers repeat least, 18% (Exhibit D) | **Months 7–9: up to $2M moves to owned only if the holdout shows over-credit; else stays $58M** |
| **Paid search**  **$22M → $19M** | Months 4–6: South geo test on ~$6.2M of branded terms | Brand-keyword ads showed no short-term lift at eBay (Blake et al. 2015) | **Months 4–6: $3M moves ($1.5M owned, $1.5M creators) if organic recovers the traffic** |
| **Influencer / affiliate**  **$16M → $17.5M** | Briefs shift to proof: wear-tests and fabric close-ups | Hypothesis; 69% product → cart drop (A1) | **+$1.5M from search for proof creators, with the search step** |
| **Paid social retargeting**  **$14M → $10M** | Re-aimed inside the line: suppression and frequency caps | No repeat advantage over organic, 23.0% vs 23.4% (A3b); the holdout tests incrementality | **Month 3: $4M moves to owned if Gate 1 passes; the holdout sizes anything more** |
| **Email, SMS, app**  **$6M → $13.5M** | Pilot: Option A's $2–3M inside $6M; grows as tranches prove (team, activation, app, creative) | Engaged buyers repeat 28.1% vs 4.7% (A2) | **Receives each step: owned share 5% → 11%** |
| **Brand / other**  **$4M, unchanged** | Unchanged; $1.0M funds one Fitting Room test | Asset-light pop-up, no store | **One-season test; stopped if attendee repeat doesn't beat a matched holdout** |

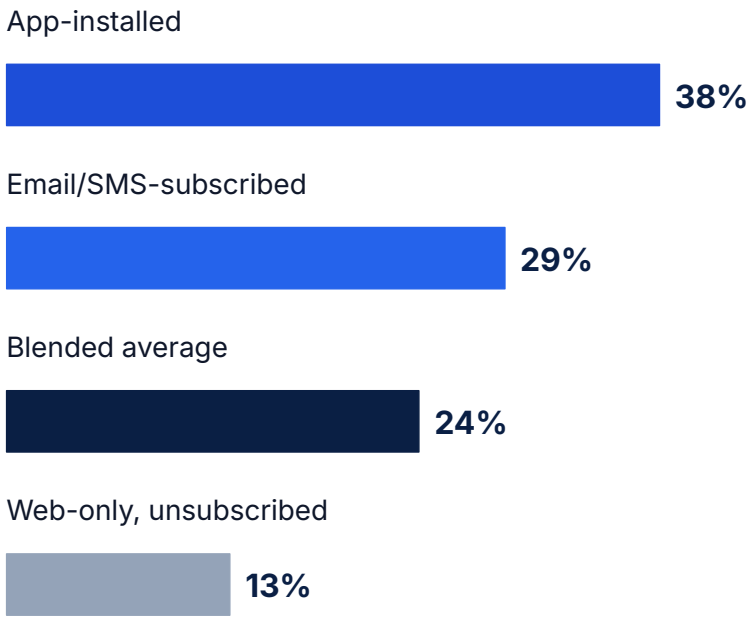
**Net change: $0. Up to $9M leaves rented lines in three steps, and each one moves only if its holdout proves it**

Source: case Exhibits G (budget), I (cost by option), D (channel CAC), N (regions); Adobe CJA A3b, A2 and Attribution IQ. Targets are our base case; South test cells assume spend follows the customer split (28%). Each step moves only on holdout proof.

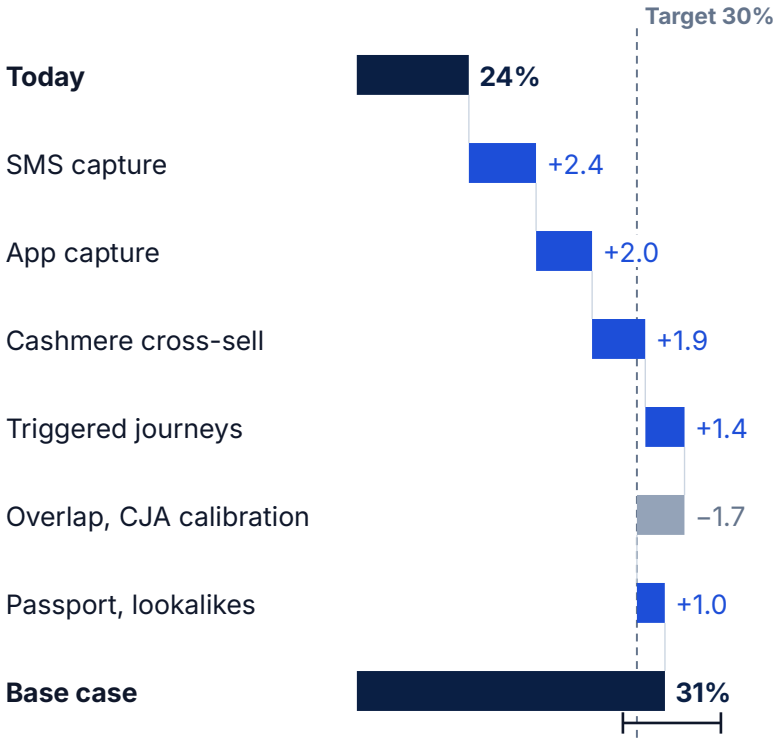
# How our levers add up to ~31% repeat

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## 90-day repeat by engagement (Exhibit E)




## How the levers reach ~31% (base case)




Axis starts at 20%. Gross lever effects come from our CJA-calibrated model; we take 25% off new levers for overlap (estimates).

### WHAT +6 POINTS IS WORTH (EXHIBIT J)

**~250,000**
incremental repeat orders a year

**~$30M**
incremental revenue

**~$13.5M**
contribution at ~45% margin

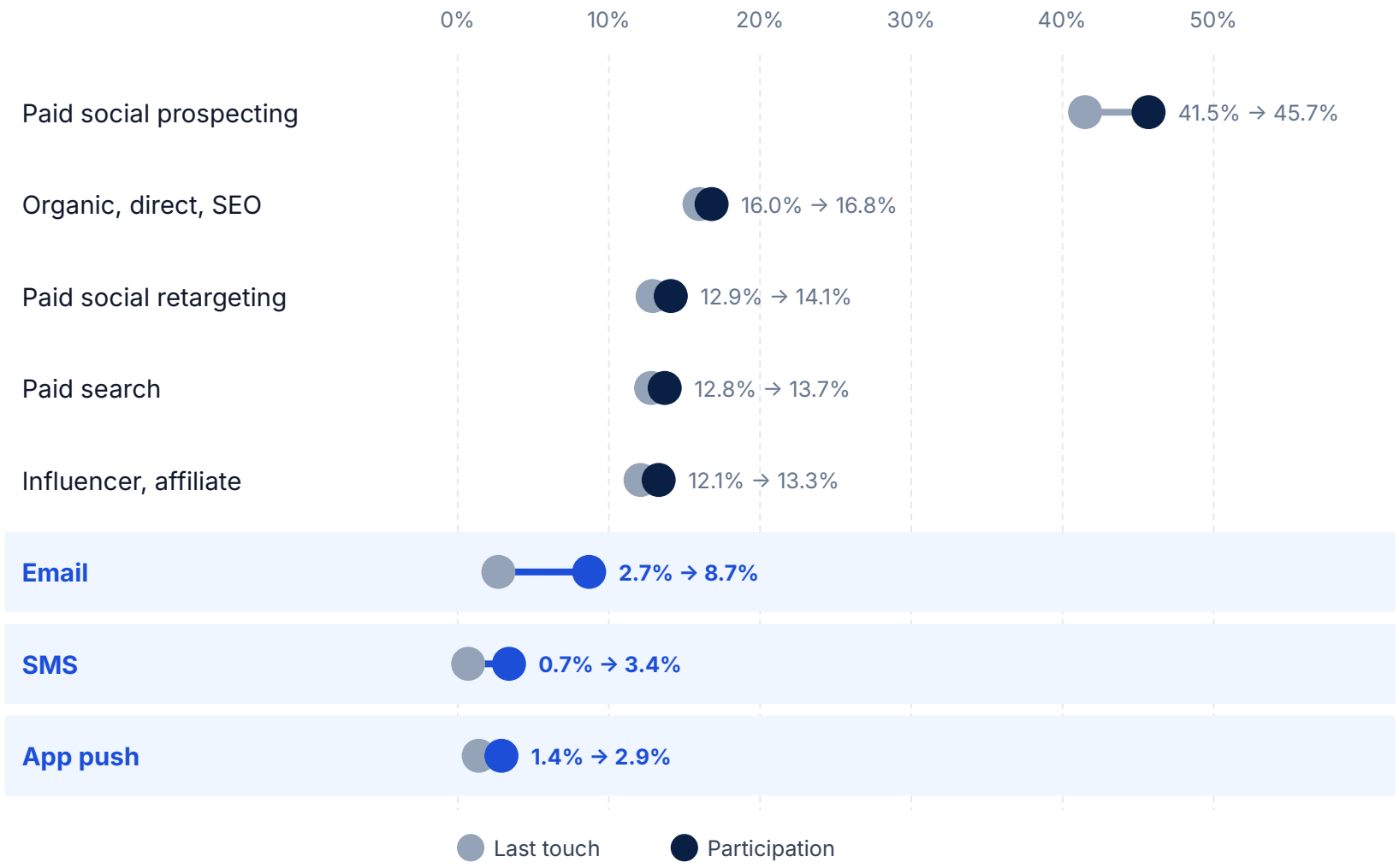
**~10–12%**
lower effective CAC at +6 pts; −12 to −14% at our +7 (strict ≈ −8%)

**Base case ~31% (range 29.5–33%) clears the +6 target; Gate 2 checks ≥ 28% at month 9**

Source: case Exhibits E (90-day repeat by engagement type) and J (impact of a 6-point gain); Adobe CJA A2, A5; lever effects are our estimates calibrated on CJA, not case figures.

# Owned channels touch 15% of revenue but get credit for ~5%

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**4.8% → 15.0%**

Owned channels: last-touch credit vs up to 15.0% of revenue they appear in (not additive)

**12.9 · 12.4 · 12.5%**

Retargeting under last touch, first touch and linear: attribution can't settle it, but holdouts can (Gordon et al. 2019)

Source: Adobe CJA Attribution IQ, Order Revenue ($337,044), Marketing Channel, Person container, 90-day lookback, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026.

# Material Journeys runs on order-linked shipping events

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**Factories and 3PL partners**
Shipment created · customs cleared · out for delivery · delivered

↓

**Order and fulfillment events**
One event stream per order, keyed to the order ID

↓

**Adobe CJA: stitched person ID**
Order ID → person; audiences; holdout assignment

↓

**Activation and journey triggers**
Pre-arrival material and care guide · delivery-day Passport and app ask · day-21 next category

↓

**Owned channels**
SMS · email · app push, under one frequency cap

## v1 uses delivery emails; we build the full version in months 3–6

### 1 Month 3–4 Map and consent

- List the shipping milestones factories and 3PLs already emit
- Agree one order-ID key with operations
- Split transactional and marketing SMS consent with Legal (CCPA)

### 2 Month 4–5 Connect

- Stream events into CJA: order ID → person ID
- Build audiences: in transit, delivered, day 21 with no second order
- Assign the 10% randomized holdout

### 3 Month 5–6 Launch and read

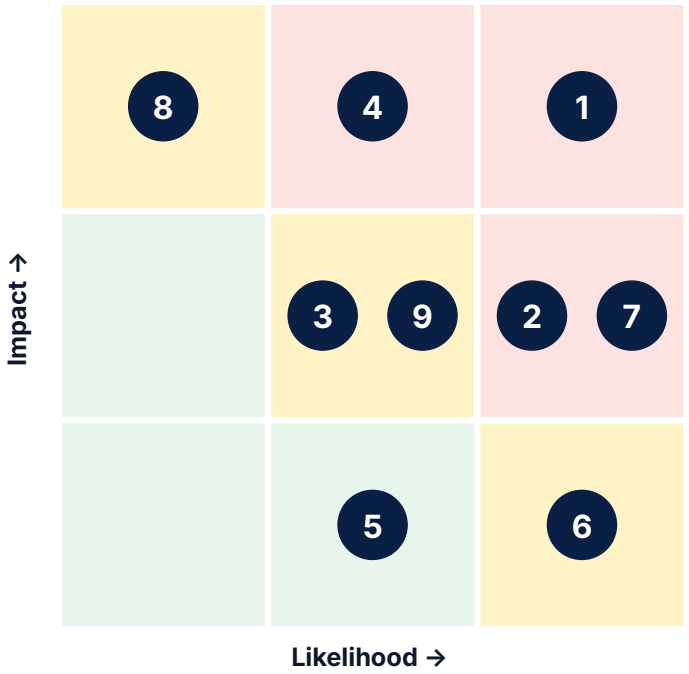
- Pre-arrival guide: how the material is made and cared for
- Delivery-day Passport and app ask; day-21 second category
- Read results against the holdout every week

**→ The tech work comes down to one thing: 3PL shipping events tied to an order ID**

Source: case section 1 (M2C model), Exhibits L and N; our build plan. Month ranges are our plan, not case figures.

# Nine risks we watch, each with a fix and a warning sign

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| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Selection bias inflates lift** | **Mitigation:** Randomized 10% holdout<br>**Early warning:** holdout gap shrinks |
| 2 | **Channel owners resist cuts** | **Mitigation:** Scorecards on incremental revenue<br>**Early warning:** escalations at the weekly council |
| 3 | **Message fatigue, unsubscribes** | **Mitigation:** Fewer, triggered sends<br>**Early warning:** unsubscribes above pre-pilot rate |
| 4 | **Consent and privacy (CCPA)** | **Mitigation:** Transactional and marketing consent split<br>**Early warning:** consent complaints |
| 5 | **The Fitting Room doesn't pay back** | **Mitigation:** One-season test<br>**Early warning:** attendee repeat no better than a matched holdout |
| 6 | **Platform or signal shock** | **Mitigation:** More owned reach; first-party lists<br>**Early warning:** CPM or match-rate drop |
| 7 | **Creative fatigue** | **Mitigation:** Fresh creative funded by Option A<br>**Early warning:** falling click and conversion rates |
| 8 | **Fewer new customers** | **Mitigation:** Prospecting budget unchanged; exclusions tested<br>**Early warning:** weekly new customers vs plan |
| 9 | **Activation set-up slips** | **Mitigation:** Start in month 0; manual list upload as fallback<br>**Early warning:** suppression lists not live by week 6 |

Source: case section 7 and Exhibit K; likelihood and impact positions are our judgment.

# Every number traces to the case, CJA or research

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## Case packet (illustrative)

- $120M budget and its six lines (Exhibit G); 4.2M active customers (A)
- CAC $48 → $62; repeat 24% vs 30–35% peers; targets +6 pts and −10% (section 3)
- Cart abandonment ~78% vs ~70% benchmark (C); retargeting CAC $31 (D)
- Repeat 38% / 29% / 13% by engagement (E); ~250K orders, ~$30M, ~$13.5M, ~10–12% CAC (J)
- Option A $2–3M inside the $6M owned line; B $0 within $14M; time to impact (I)
- Regions (N); ~$180B market (section 2); app 22% of sessions (A)

## Adobe CJA (our sandbox)

- 60,000 → 2,592 people; 69% and 77% drop-offs; 25,227 = 36,566 − 11,339 (Fallout)
- 11,610 cart paths: 6,088 to checkout, 1 to email (Flow)
- 28.1% vs 4.7%; 24.5% of buyers, 66% of repeaters; 10.5% overall (A2)
- App 21.5% (n = 265), SMS 11.7% (n = 315) after order one (A5)
- Week 2: 5.6% vs 2.1%; half of engaged repeats in weeks 1–4 (Cohort)
- Category repeat, cashmere 40.7% (A6); 23.0% vs 23.4%, 45.5% (A3b); 4.8% vs 15.0% (AIQ)

## Public data (cited)

- ATT opt-in 35% (Adjust, Q2 2025) to 50% (AppsFlyer, Apr 2025)
- Meta average price per ad +12% year on year (Q2 2026 results)
- Meta Advantage+ defaults (2025); TikTok US joint venture (Jan 2026)
- Consumer sentiment record low (UMich, 2026); apparel prices up with tariffs (Cotton Inc.)
- Shein to buy Everlane (May 2026); Amazon ads $19.8B, +26% (Q2 2026)
- Census: 17.1% online (Q2 2026); McKinsey 71%; Tapestry 6.8M; WSI v. Quince (2026)

## Derived, or team design

- +29% = $62 ÷ $48 − 1; $1.43 = $6M ÷ 4.2M; 60% = ($58M + $14M) ÷ $120M
- 2.7× = 5.6 ÷ 2.1; a third = 4.8 ÷ 15.0; ~5,500 = 11,610 − 6,088 − 1
- +6 pts: 6 ÷ 25 = 24% (app), 6 ÷ 16 = 37.5% (email/SMS); ~29% and ~59% after A2→A5 haircuts; web-only ≥ 31% (38a + 29s + 13w = 24)
- Base case ~31% = 24 + 7.7 gross − 1.7 overlap + 1.0 new levers (EST); gates at months 3 and 9
- Timing (1h, 24h, delivery, day 7, 21, 60); 30-day recent buyers; gift picks 14 days ahead
- $9M = $4M + $3M + $2M (targets, appendix 21); South tests 28% (Exh. N) × $22M = ~$6.2M, × $58M = ~$16.2M

Case figures are the packet's illustrative estimates, never Quince disclosures. CJA figures come from our sandbox, 60,000 people, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026.

# Sources: case data, our CJA project and public research

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## Case and Adobe CJA

**Quince case packet, "Closing the Loop"**
Case Competition World Cup, Graduate Track, 9 Oct 2026; Exhibits A–O, all illustrative

**Adobe CJA, Quince Case Data View**
Team project: 60,000 people, 125,521 events, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026 (appendix 9–13)

**Adobe Experience League: publishing CJA audiences**
Audiences activate via Real-Time CDP or Journey Optimizer
experienceleague.adobe.com/en/docs/analytics-platform/using/cja-compon

**Shein to buy Everlane (NPR via Michigan Public, 22 May 2026)**
Everlane agreed to be acquired; price not disclosed
michiganpublic.org/2026-05-22/shein-buys-everlane-which-sold-millennia

**Gordon, Zettelmeyer, Bhargava & Chapsky (2019)**
A Comparison of Approaches to Advertising Measurement. Marketing Science 38(2)
doi.org/10.1287/mksc.2018.1135

**Blake, Nosko & Tadelis (2015)**
Consumer Heterogeneity and Paid Search Effectiveness. Econometrica 83(1)
doi.org/10.3982/ECTA12423

## Market and industry research

**Adjust: ATT opt-in rates 2025**
35% average opt-in among users shown the prompt, Q2 2025
adjust.com/blog/att-opt-in-rates-2025

**AppsFlyer: four years after ATT (Apr 2025)**
About 50% of users consent to tracking globally
appsflyer.com/company/newsroom/pr/post-att-growth-2/

**Meta Q2 2026 results (Adweek, Jul 2026)**
Average price per ad +12% and ad impressions +14% year on year
adweek.com/?p=1954104

**Meta Advantage+ as the default campaign setup**
Audiences treated as suggestions unless set as limits (Jon Loomer)
jonloomer.com/advantage-plus-campaign-setup-targeting/

**TikTok US joint venture (The Register, 23 Jan 2026)**
Oracle, Silver Lake and MGX among investors
theregister.com/2026/01/23/jv_announces_tiktok_us_acquisition/

**University of Michigan Surveys of Consumers**
Record low in May 2026; 46.3 preliminary in October 2026
sca.isr.umich.edu/

**Cotton Incorporated, Executive Cotton Update (Jun 2026)**
US garment prices rose sharply in early 2026 amid tariffs
ecotextile.com/?p=63440

**Competition and market, added:** Amazon Q2 2026 ads · Shein/Temu US (CNBC) · Everlane sale (Bloomberg Law) · Fast Retailing FY2025 · Tapestry FY2025 · WSI v. Quince ruling · Census e-commerce · McKinsey personalization

Case figures are the packet's illustrative estimates, never Quince disclosures. Links checked in October 2026.